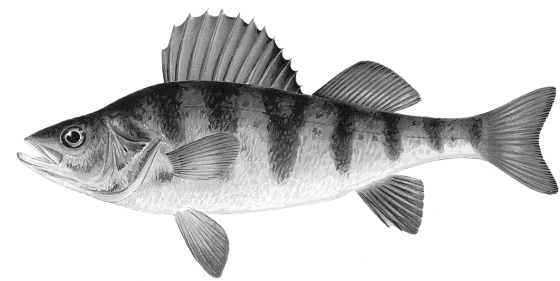


Yellow Perch

Perca flavescens

A daylight schooling fish — and the walleye’s opposite



Yellow or Barred Perch — chromolithograph by S. F. Denton, New York Commissioners of Fisheries, Game and Forests, 1896–1902. Public domain; converted to grayscale for printing.

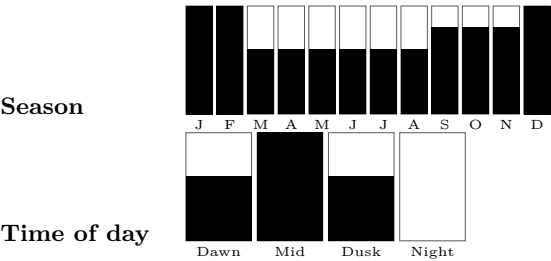
Tell it apart Six to eight dark **vertical bars** over a yellow-green body, with orange lower fins. Two separate dorsal fins, the first spiny. Unmistakable.

Size here 6–10 in. A 10 in perch is a fine fish and among the best eating in either lake.

Spawn 45–52 °F, April, and unlike any other fish here the female lays a long accordion-folded ribbon of eggs draped over weeds and brush. You will see them in the shallows.

Eats Insect larvae, small crustaceans, minnows and fish eggs. Perch are also the primary food of walleye and pike — which is exactly why they school.

Habit **A daytime feeder.** Perch shut down at night, when walleye switch on. They travel in tight schools on the bottom.



Where

Pine The deep weed edge at spot **5**, the flats around the base of the bar **4**, and the 15–30 ft bottom generally.

North Spots **1, 3** and **4**. Shallower than on Pine because of the stain.

Bottom Perch stay on or near the bottom on clean sand, gravel or the base of weeds. If you are more than a foot off the bottom you are fishing over them.

Winter One of the best ice fish in either lake, on the same 15–30 ft flats.

How

Best rig A small jig tipped with a minnow head, a piece of crawler or a waxworm, fished right on the bottom. Or a drop-shot with a very short tag, *see the **drop-shot** sheet*.

Move to find them Perch schools are tight. If you catch two and then nothing, the school moved — move with it rather than waiting.

Stay on them When you find a school, drop straight back down immediately. A hooked fish drags the school with it and a slow re-bait costs you the whole group.

Eating Excellent — firm, white, mild. This is the fish worth keeping a limit of.

The lesson to teach

Perch and walleye eat the same food in the same water but never at the same hour: one has eyes built for daylight, the other for dusk. That single fact explains most of the daily rhythm of both lakes.

Regulations on these waters, 2026–27. Panfish: 25 per day in total, open all year, no minimum length. *These change; only the Wisconsin DNR’s current publication for this exact water body is authoritative.*